European Operational Program for Exchange of Weather Radar Information (OPERA)

OPERA production data and software release 2026b

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Project:	OPERA Production release 2026b
Production Centre:	DWD, GeoSphere Austria, KNMI and Météo-France
Application Domain:	CUMULUS, STRATUS, CIRRUS and NIMBUS production
Processing Software:	CIRRUS 1.7.0 (including BALTRAD version dated 2025-10-01), NIMBUS (including BALTRAD version 3.1.0, dated 2026-06-09) NIMBUS

Reference	Date	Author(s)	Content
OPERA_release_notes_20261028	14.09.2026	Annakaisa von Lerber	First draft
OPERA_release_notes_CIRRUS-1.7	28.10.2026	Milka Radojevic	CIRRUS production
OPERA_release_notes_20261028_GSA	29.10.2026	Vera Meyer	NIMBUS production
OPERA_release_notes_20261102	02.11.2026	Annakaisa von Lerber	final version for commenting
OPERA_release_notes_20261102_GSA_KS	02.11.2026	Klaus Stephan	added comments

1. OPERA production data release 2026b

1. Data update
    - 6 new radars existing sites in Spain (AEMET). Please note change in the node name:
        - LEMM41 (renamed node from eslid to esatp)
        - LEMM43 (renamed node from esval to escll)
        - LEMM44 (renamed node from esmur to esftn)
        - LEMM46 (renamed node from escor to esccd)
        - LEMM48 (renamed node from essan to essls)
        - LEMM54 (renamed node from espma to esllm
    - 1 new radar new site in Spain (AEMET): LEMM63 (node=esgrm)
    - 1 new radar existing site in France (Météo France): LFPW64 (node=frche)

2. Update of filenames
    - Renaming reflectivity volume files with the incoming data for Belgium radars: EBUM41, EBUM42 & EBUM43
        - Belgium previously delivered four reflectivity products (TH, wind-optimised DBZH, best DBZH, and Doppler-filtered DBZH). Following a filename convention change, delivery of the Doppler-filtered DBZH products has been discontinued.

3. Data updates (not affecting CIRRUS production)
    - New data processing, transmission & elevations for all radars in Finland (FMI):
        - EFKL wind-optimized scans available (except the lowest elevation angle 0.7°) in wind profile production and in QC volumes
        - EFKL wind-optimized scan (lowest elevation angle 0.7°) available without NIMBUS QC in 15 min - QC volumes
    - Elevation angle change for one radar in Hungary (HungaroMet):
        - HABP43 with new elevation angle (node=hunap)
    - HABP wind-optimized scans available without NIMBUS QC in 15 min - QC volumes
    - Change in radial resolution for three radars and additions of parameters in QC-volumes in Poland (IMGW):
        - for all SOWR radars new parameters included in QC volume files (DBZH, VRADH, and TH)
        - 3 SOWR radars with rscale changed from 1000m to 500m (SOWR46 (node= plswi), 49 (node = pluzr), and 50 (node = plgsa))
    - Notes to Belgium incoming data
        - Changes in filenames required reconfiguration in NIMBUS
        - Reflectivities for wind-optimized scans are available without NIMBUS QC in 15 min - QC volumes (as before)
        - The QC'ed volumes files will change, due to the discontinue of the Doppler-filtered DBZH

2. OPERA production software release 2026b

1. CUMULUS and STRATUS
    - RMDCN data transfer to CUMULUS is shut down by the end of December 2026.

2. CIRRUS (version 1.7.0)
    - No software updates

3. NIMBUS
    - No changes in data process chain

4. Open Radar Data API
    - migration to new European Weather Cloud infrastructure on November 24th (separate release notes)

Contact

OPERA support: support.opera@eumetnet.eu

Supportive documents:

Example composite files can be found: https://github.com/opera-radar/opera-releases/tree/main/examples/example_files_release_2026b